



Venom's upcoming movie

Spider-Man's villain Venom is getting his own standalone movie and will be coming to theatres on October next year. <http://digit.in/VenomM>



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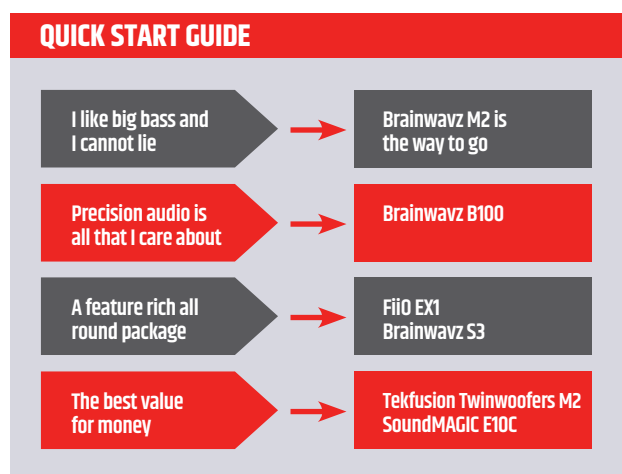
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SOUNDMAGIC E10C

We've been fans of SoundMagic's E10 series for a long time now (much more than the overrated PL30s). The E10M was for a long time our go to recommendation for the ₹2000 to ₹2500 price bracket. **Build & Design:** In terms of design, the driver housing looks exactly like the E10M while the cable is the one used on the E10S. The internal wiring is different though. The E10C has a 3-button remote that can automatically switch between Apple and Android smartphones – pretty neat. It's like they took the E10S and changed its cable to have a better remote and an angled input jack.

Performance: Between the E10C and its predecessor the E10S there is no difference in sound signature. It's the same vibrant signature that we've come to love over the ages (especially given that it comes at such a price point). The question therefore isn't which E10 sounds better (it's the E10M in case you were wondering), the question is, how does the E10C compare to the other similarly priced IEM in this test? With a fair amount of listening we find that the locally designed Tekfusion Twinwoofers M2 inches ever so slightly ahead of the Japanese competition. If you look at the scores in the table alongside this can be clearly seen. Is the E10C bad? Of course not! In fact, with the compatibility enhanced wiring and now three button remote it's an improvement over the older version.

Verdict: Objectively, the Tekfusion Twinwoofers M2 is a slightly better buy in terms of pure audio performance. But the two are so close that you



can almost substitute one for the other depending on which one is more easily available. Your decision can sway in favour of the E10C on ancillary factors too such as the availability of a computer adapter included in the bundle – if that's an important consideration for you. Or even the three button remote as opposed to the single button one found on the Twinwoofers.

PROS

- ➕ Great value
- ➕ Decent sound

CONS

- ➖ Detail could've been better

BRAINWAVZ M2

The M2 has for long been a staple on any online roundup / listing featuring the best in-ears within this price range, but the company "officially" launched it only in Oct 2016. It's been a favourite for good reason. The entire M series from Brainwavz delivers great sound with each variant being uniquely tuned to suit every preference.

Build & Design: Unlike the Brainwavz M1 which looks a little

too plain than the Brainwavz M2 has a few niceties thrown in like the silver accents.

Features & Performance: The Brainwavz M2 is decidedly bass heavy. In fact the bass is so accentuated, we've given it the title of "Bass King" in this test. But the bass did tend to get overpowering. The M2 is also very sensitive, so will sound very loud even at low input volume.

Incidentally, we also had the Brainwavz M1 lying around and although it's not included in this test it's probably worthwhile discussing what the differences are between the two. In terms of cable quality they are both the same, but that ₹500 extra you pay for the M2 gets you two things: firstly a pair of better looking headphones and second, a significant bump in the bass department.

Verdict: If thumping bass is very important to you, and a microphone is not you can't

go wrong with the M2. If you want similar overall performance but with a mic, you'd do well with the 1More Single Drive. It's cheaper too.

PROS

- ➕ Bass king at this price point

CONS

- ➖ No mic

WINNERS

Best Buy: The best buy analysis was very close in this test. In fact, the result surprised us quite a bit. Considering the kind of legendary audio quality the E10 has been known for, we expected bagging this award would be a cinch for the E10C. But the Tekfusion Twinwoofers M2 provided just a little more performance per rupee. The Twinwoofers M2 therefore wins our Best Buy Award for this test. However, the E10C was so close you'd do well going with either simply on whichever one is available. **Best Performer:** The undisputed winner in terms of pure sound quality was the Brainwavz B100. It has a few problems with it though such as nothing to write home about in terms of looks, or the fact that it doesn't have a microphone. But if you are looking for an in-ear headphone that will reproduce most genres as true to source as possible in this price range, then this is the device for you.

Editor's Pick: The surprisingly fun, spacious and overall high scoring unit in this test was the Brainwavz S3. It has great passive isolation, a tangle free cable with microphone and the unit feels like it should be able to take regular wear and tear of being a daily driver. For this, it is our Editor's Pick for this test. **4**

CONTACTS

SoundMAGIC	www.soundmagic.in
FiiO	www.fii.co.in
1More	https://india.1more.com/
a-JAYS	www.headphonezone.in
Audio-Technica	www.audio-technica.com
Tekfusion	www.tekfusiontechnologies.com